

HCIN 620 – Information and Interaction Design

Milestone 1: Project focus

The goal of this assignment is to create the platform on which your team will publish all information pertaining to your approved topic. Your team will continue to add content to the platform over the course of the semester until it fulfills the requirements of the project in these phases:

1. **Project Focus** (this phase: Milestone 01)
2. Contextual Inquiry
3. Personas
4. Lo-fi Prototype
5. Hi-fi Prototype & Testing

At the end of the semester, you will have a digital prototype of a design that proposes a solution to an existing problem.

Requirements

Choose platform of your choice (e.g., Github Pages) to create a website for your team. Note that you'll have to submit the source code for the site at the end of the semester.

Part 1: Project Overview Page

- On your website, create a homepage that identifies:
 - Your team
 - The stakeholder(s) and potential user(s)
 - The problem you plan to fix
 - The general direction for a solution
- This information^ must be on a single page.
 - Think of this page as the *executive summary* of a report that will follow on subsequent pages.
- The content on the page must be simple, plainly worded content *without* supporting references.
 - Note: you will provide details (and citations) for the statements on the page later.

Part 2: Project Focus

Create a second page, linked from the homepage, titled: “Project Focus”

The purpose of this section is to identify *real* needs or problems that exist. It’s one thing to “spit ball” based on personal opinion - but that’s not the purpose of HCIN-620. You need to find supporting evidence that the problem is real and has impact on people. You should complete the Holtzblatt (Rapid Contextual Design, Ch 2) reading before choosing a topic to determine the appropriate scope.

On this page,

- **Indicate the topic** (this can be a *working title*; you can change it later)
 - Make the topic text descriptive but avoid catchy names or attempts to propose product branding (that’s marketing’s job ...and you’re not marketing!)
- **Problem statement:** Discuss the motivation for selecting this topic and find supporting evidence. It could be for example, *due to the lack of attention...* or *it is recently a trending topic* (show examples where you can), or it is out of personal motivation for you, or any other motivation.
 - Cite existing research, news, or other articles to show the need for a solution. Whenever you make an assertion about the existence of an issue, you need to provide evidence.
 - If you (personally) experience dissatisfaction in your interaction with a digital system or process, ask yourself: *what is the impact of this in my life? Are others impacted in a similar way? Or, how would my life be better if there was an alternative?*
 - Answers to these questions will lead you to keywords you can use to find related research on the topic.
 - Add your references to a “References” section at the bottom of the page, and insert inline cites to those references whenever you make an assertion in your text, for example:
“Poorly designed health communication materials reduce comprehension (Kong 2025) and can negatively affect health decision-making (Nguyen 2021; Patel et al. 2023).” and then provide the full reference later in the document.
- **Solution:** Propose a (or multiple) solution(s) to the problem above.
 - Keep the proposal high-level, focusing on the *direction* a solution will take without specifying the details of design or implementation.
 - Describe what is missing from the existing situation/solutions, and how the new solution addresses the gaps.
- **Stakeholders/Users:** Specify the stakeholders and potential users of the solution
 - Consider the following points about them: goals, worries, how to involve them, and how to communicate the design and progress to them.

- Note: In this project, you will need to find participants from these user groups, so whoever you identify as a stakeholder and/or potential user, make sure you can find them!
- BTW - make sure you know the difference between a *stakeholder* and a *potential user*. They may overlap or be completely different depending on your topic.

General Requirements

- Throughout the document there must be no superfluous formatting, text, or imagery that does not directly support the goal of the project: *to deliver a digital prototype of a solution to a real world problem*.
 - No “eye candy”
 - No promotional or sales information

Turn It In: myCourses

One team member (could be any of you) needs to submit the URL to the **Milestone 01: Project Focus** assignment in myCourses.

Note: initially, everyone on the team will get the same grade against the rubric. The grade could be re-balanced among team members based on their contributions to the project.

Suggestion: keep a log of everything you do and when you do it, having to do with this project. Use your group’s Slack channel to keep track of the documents, communication, and individual deliverables. It will be good to have this information handy when a meeting becomes necessary to discuss your contributions.